

JAZZ/ROCK VOICINGS
FOR THE CONTEMPORARY
KEYBOARD PLAYER

BY DAN
HAERLE

DAN HAERLE

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FOREWORD

As one who is extremely interested in the development of methods and materials pertaining to the study of jazz-rock music, I am especially delighted to see the release of this fine book by Dan Haerle. I expect that it will soon become a standard method at schools with jazz programs, at music camps, and in private study, with or without an instructor. I also see the book as a valuable aid to students of composition-arranging for learning voicings, voice-leading, chord function, altered dominants, quartal harmony, polychords, chord substitution, melody harmonization, chromatic parallel motion, and in general, the harmonic language of our time.

An outstanding pianist-arranger-teacher, Dan Haerle is certainly the right individual to author such a book as this. His wide experience lends authority to his use of categories with regard to the relative commonness of specific voicings. Having taught with Dan for the University of Miami jazz program, I know that his methods are thorough, current, and effective. I highly recommend this book to all pianists and arrangers of the jazz-rock idiom.

Jerry Coker
Big Creek Music Seminary

INTRODUCTION

This book is intended as an intermediate method for jazz and rock keyboard players. Therefore, a basic understanding of the construction of common chord types is necessary for the application of principles outlined in the book. As there are many sources of this information already available, it is the author's desire to provide only that information relating to the handling of chords which it is felt that most students are usually seeking. In addition, principles of chord function and substitution have been included since an understanding of these is essential.

The format of the book is based on a categorization of chords according to common usage and basic structure. Although the use of root position block chords is certainly possible, their construction is obvious and, as such, they will not be discussed here. Many voicings are presented in typical harmonic functions since this is an inseparable part of their nature. All examples relate to the key of C (major or minor) to allow for a comparative analysis. An understanding of each voicing, as to the adjacent intervals and the chord members included, will greatly aid the player in adding that voicing to his harmonic language. Naturally, all voicings should be memorized and learned in all keys to achieve the greatest ease in using them.

The book does not presume to be exhaustive in its inclusion of voicings; to do so would be literally impossible. However, a representative sampling of voicings in common use is shown and these should suggest many slight variations. Moreover, principles of polychords, suspended fourth chords, chords voiced mainly in fourths, and electronic keyboard applications are included to help the young keyboard player gain an understanding of current devices of the '70's.

GENERAL NOTES

- 1 Any of the three or four note voicings in this book may be used in the following ways:
 - A As a chord played by the left hand while the right hand creates a melodic improvisation.
 - B As a chord played by the left hand to which the right hand adds selected tones for a fuller voicing.
 - C As a chord played by the right hand while supplying the root (and 3rd, 5th or 7th) with the left hand in accompanying other soloists.
- 2 In connecting chords, individual chord tones should move smoothly to a tone in the next chord, usually stepwise. Common tones between two successive chords may be retained or moved stepwise if a resolution causes duplication of a tone.
- 3 The 3rd and/or the 7th of the chord should normally be present in every voicing.
- 4 In progressions of a 5th downward (4th upward), the following is always true:
 - A The 3rd of a chord has the same letter name as the 7th of the next but may require a chromatic alteration.
 - B The 7th of a chord should normally resolve downward stepwise to the 3rd of the next chord.
- 5 In showing the voice-leading from one chord to another, the following method is used in this book:
 - A A straight line angled upward or downward indicates stepwise motion, usually in the scale of the key.
 - B A curved line indicates a skip of a third or more.
 - C The absence of either symbol indicates a lack of motion or a tone which is in common with both chords.
- 6 Generally speaking, the basic three or four note voicings should be played in the vicinity of middle C on the keyboard. Limits of approximately an octave above or below will assure best results by preventing the voicing from assuming a quality of either thinness or muddiness.

THREE NOTE VOICINGS

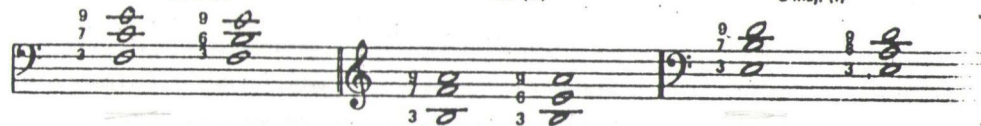
(unaltered)

The voicings shown here relate to the II chord which is usually minor, the V chord which is usually dominant, and the I chord which is major in a major key. The category A and Category B voicings are the most common although category C voicings are used widely.

CATEGORY A: Voicings built on the 3rd of the chord.
D mi (II)

G7 (V)

C Maj. (I)

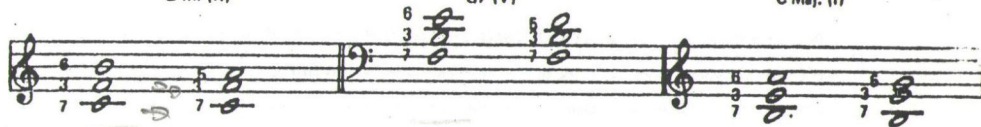


CATEGORY B: Voicings built on the 7th of the chord.

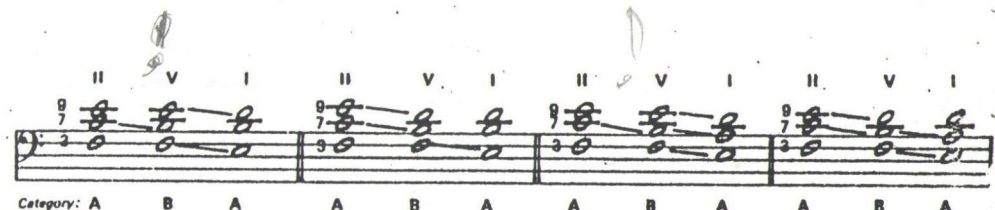
D mi (II)

G7 (V)

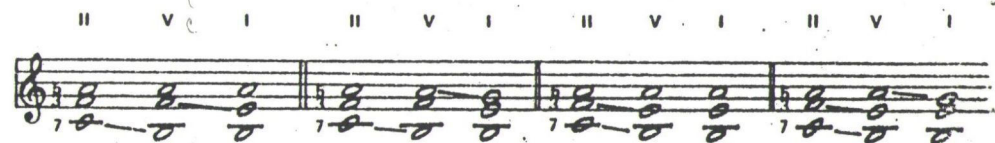
C Maj. (I)



In the following II-V-I progressions, it is important to observe the relationship of category A and category B voicings in the connection of the chords.



Category: A B A A B A A B A A B A



Category: B A B B A B B A B B A B

CATEGORY C: Voicings built on other than the 3rd or 7th which sometimes omit either the 3rd or the 7th or both.

Dmi. (II) 4 G7 (V) 7 C Maj. (I)

In the following II-V-I progressions, category C voicings are used exclusively or combined with category A and B chords.

II V I II V I II V I II V I

Category: C C C C C C C C A C B A

II V I II V I II V I II V I

Category: C B A C C C C C C B C A C

FOUR NOTE VOICINGS (Unaltered)

CATEGORY A: Voicings built on the 3rd of the chord.

Dmi. (II) 9 G7 (V) 9 C Maj. (I) 9

CATEGORY B: Voicings built on the 7th of the chord.

Dmi. (II) 6 G7 (V) 5 C Maj. (I) 5

II V I II V I II V I II V I

Category: A B A A B A A B A A B A

II V I II V I II V I II V I

Category: B A B B A B B A B B A B

CATEGORY C: Voicings built on tones other than the 3rd or 7th which sometimes omit either the 3rd or the 7th or both.

Dmi. (II) 3 G7 (V) 4 C Maj. (I)

II V I II V I II V I II V I

Category: C C C C C C C B A C B A

II V I II V I II V I II V I

Category: C C C C C C C A C C A B

ALTERED DOMINANT 7th VOICINGS

CATEGORY A: Volcings built on the 3rd of the chord.

ALTERED 5th VOICINGS:

G-5 G+5 G7-5 G7+5 G-5(+11) G7-9 G7+9 G7-9 G7+9

ALTERED 9th VOICINGS:

ALTERED 5th and 9th VOICINGS:

The image shows a musical staff with eight measures of music. Each measure contains a G7 chord with an altered 5th and 9th. The voicings are as follows:

- Measure 1: G7 -9 (5th: Bb, 9th: F)
- Measure 2: G7 -9 (5th: Bb, 9th: F)
- Measure 3: G7 +9 (5th: B, 9th: F#)
- Measure 4: G7 +9 (5th: B, 9th: F#)
- Measure 5: G7 -9 (5th: Bb, 9th: F)
- Measure 6: G7 -9 (5th: Bb, 9th: F)
- Measure 7: G7 -9 (5th: Bb, 9th: F)
- Measure 8: G7 +9 (5th: B, 9th: F#)

ALTERED 5th and 9th VOICINGS:

CATEGORY B: Voicings built on the 7th of the chord.

ALTERED 5th VOICINGS:

G7-5 G7+5 G9-5 G9+5 G13-5(+11) G7-9 G-9 G7-9 G7+9 G-9

ALTERED 9th VOICINGS:

ALTERED 5th and 9th VOICINGS:

Handwritten musical notation on a single staff, showing various chords and intervals. The notation includes notes, accidentals, and chord symbols (G7, G) with numerical figures (e.g., -5, +5, -9, +9) indicating intervals or fingerings. The staff is divided into measures by vertical bar lines.

CATEGORY C: Voicings built on notes other than the 3rd or 7th which sometimes omit either the 3rd or 7th or both.

ALTERED 5th VOICINGS:

[illegible]

ALTERED 9th VOICINGS:

G7-9 G add-9 G7+9 G add+9 G7-9 G7+9 G7-9⁺⁹



ALTERED 5th and 9th VOICINGS:

$\overset{-9}{G13-5}$ $\overset{-9}{G7-5}$ $\overset{-9}{G7+5}$ (add -9) $G+6$ $\overset{+9}{G7-6}$ $\overset{+9}{G7+6}$ (ar.) $G+5$

Some possibilities for chord connection using dominant 7th voicings with chromatic alterations: (II-V progression)

MAJOR:

1. D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^-

2. D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^-

3. D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^- $\text{G}^{\text{b}9}$ $\text{C}^{\text{b}9}$ D^-

Category: A B A A B A A B A

D-^{b5} G^{b5} C^{b5}9 *D-^{b5} G^{b5} C^{b5}9* *D-^{b5} G^{b5} C^{b5}9*

Category: B A B B A B B A B

Category: C C A B A B B A B

pad: maj: min: b5

MINOR:

Category: A B A A B A A B A

Category: B A B B A B B A B

Category: C C A C B A C A B

TWO-HAND VOICING PRINCIPLES

There are two main approaches to voicing chords for two hands: (1) A three or four note voicing with notes added in either the left or right hand and (2) A chord of four notes or more which are evenly distributed between the two hands.

In general, the right hand should not merely duplicate the left. The following are poor examples of two-hand voicings.

POOR

Often a simple triad, seventh (7th) or ninth (9th) chord may be opened up by dropping or raising one or more chord members an octave.

To a basic left hand voicing, various forms of the triad may be added.

C9

This musical example shows a C9 chord in the left hand (root position) with six different triad voicings in the right hand. The triads are: C major (C-E-G), C minor (C-Eb-G), C augmented (C-E-G#), C diminished (C-Eb-Gb), C major 7 (C-E-G-B), and C minor 7 (C-Eb-G-Bb).

Chord tones which are either present or not found in the left-hand voicing may be added in octaves to give emphasis to them.

C9

This musical example shows a C9 chord in the left hand with six different triad voicings in the right hand. Each triad has one or more chord tones (3rd, 7th, 9th) added in octaves to provide emphasis.

Major or minor triads found within the complete 13th chord may be superimposed onto the left-hand voicing.

Cmi.9

This musical example shows a Cmi.9 chord in the left hand with six different triad voicings in the right hand. The triads are: C major (C-E-G), C minor (C-Eb-G), C major 7 (C-E-G-B), C minor 7 (C-Eb-G-Bb), C major 9 (C-E-G-B-A), and C minor 9 (C-Eb-G-Bb-A).

Various other triads may be superimposed to create alterations in the basic chord. The left-hand voicing may have to be adjusted.

C7+9, C7-9, C7+5, C13-9, C13

This musical example shows five different altered chords in the left hand: C7+9, C7-9, C7+5, C13-9, and C13. Each chord has a specific triad voicing in the right hand that creates the alteration.

The basic voicing may be played by the right hand while supplying fundamental chord tones in the left hand.

C9

This musical example shows a C9 chord in the right hand (basic voicing) with the fundamental chord tones (root, 3rd, 7th, 9th) in the left hand.

CHORDS VOICED IN FOURTHS

Chords voiced in intervals of a fourth (2½ steps) have a light, floating quality which contributes to a feeling to any harmonic texture. This is primarily for two reasons: (1) Since the voicings are arranged in fourths, there is less of a thickness, or clusterish nature to the sonority, and (2) Since two adjacent notes of a fourth imply a suspended harmony with at least three resolutions, there is a noncommittal nature to the harmony (see EXAMPLE 1).

EXAMPLE 1

This musical example shows a sequence of chords voiced in fourths, illustrating the light, floating quality mentioned in the text.

There are many three and four note voicings built exclusively in fourths which are possible in relation to the main chord families. These may be used as left-hand voicings or may be played with both hands, adding fundamental chord tones in the left hand.

EXAMPLE 2

Major family (C Maj. 7, C Maj. 6/9, etc.)

This musical example shows a sequence of chords from the major family (C Maj. 7, C Maj. 6/9, etc.) voiced in fourths. Some notes are marked as suspended (sus.).

Dominant 7th family (C7, C13, etc.)

This musical example shows a sequence of chords from the dominant 7th family (C7, C13, etc.) voiced in fourths. Some notes are marked as suspended (sus.).

Minor family (C min. 7, C min. 6/9, etc.)

This musical example shows a sequence of chords from the minor family (C min. 7, C min. 6/9, etc.) voiced in fourths. Some notes are marked as suspended (sus.).

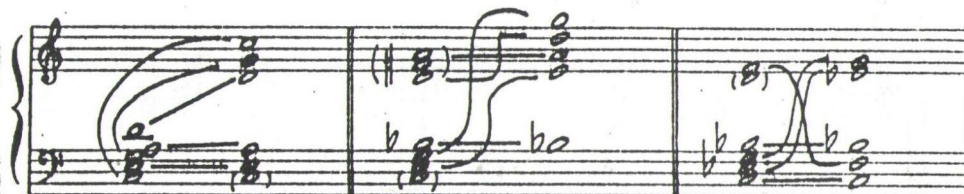
Five and six note voicings which are not built exclusively in perfect fourths are probably the most commonly used voicings. Any major, minor or dominant chord may be rearranged so that its voicing consists primarily of intervals of a fourth.

EXAMPLE 3

C Maj. 6 9

C 13

C Mi 11



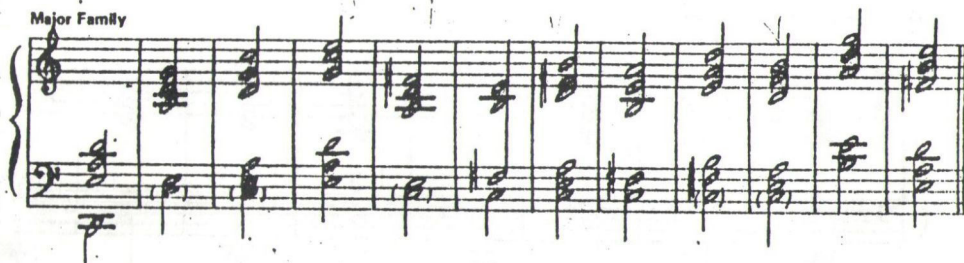
Some factors which affect the quality of fourthy voicings seem to be the following:

- (1) What note is the highest and lowest note in the voicing?
 - A. A major 3rd or major 7th of the chord on top tends to brighten the sound of the voicing. A raised 11th has the same effect.
 - B. If the bass note is the root of the chord, the voicing has more strength, but if it is absent the quality is considerably lighter.
- (2) What is the interval between the highest and lowest notes of the voicing?
 - A. An interval of a major 3rd on top of two or more fourths greatly brightens the sound of the voicing.
 - B. A major 3rd interval on the bottom of the chord adds to its clarity whereas a dissonant interval such as a major 7th tends to obscure it.

In a context of voicings that are primarily built in fourths, voicings which combine perfect fourths and augmented fourths will fit in well and tend to sustain the general fourthy quality. This is particularly true of minor harmonies where a tri-tone (*augmented fourth*) exists between the 3rd and 6th of the chord, and in dominant harmonies where a tri-tone exists between the 3rd and 7th of the chord. This can easily be seen by looking at the voicings shown in Example 4.

EXAMPLE 4

Major Family



EXAMPLE 4 continued

Dominant 7th Family

(sus.)

(sus.)



Minor Family

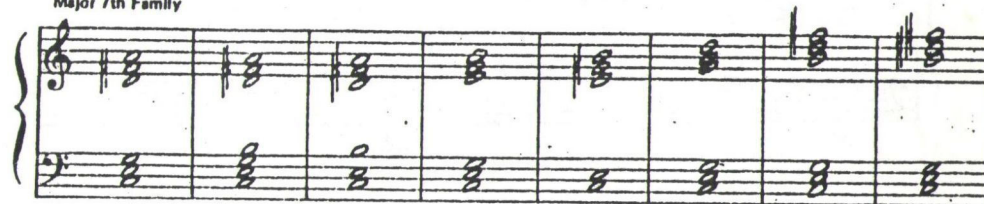


POLYCHORDAL VOICINGS

A polychord is simply a combination of two or more chords to create an extended or altered harmonic sonority. Generally, most polychords consist of only two chords; the bottom chord is usually a triad or seventh chord and the upper chord is almost always a triad. Polychord symbols are written as fractions, thereby giving a graphic picture of the actual chord structure. The bottom chord may be a major or minor triad, or a major, minor or dominant 7th chord. Other 7th chord structures are possible as the foundation of the polychord, but not common. The following are the polychords which are usually found in conjunction with the three main chord families.

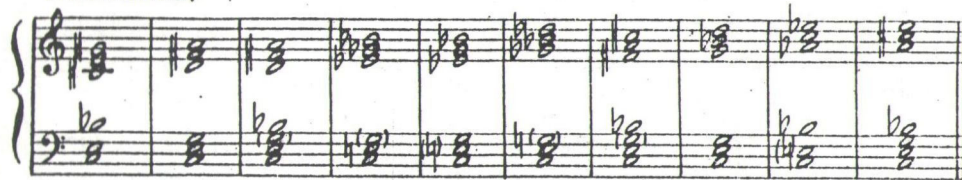
EXAMPLE 1

Major 7th Family

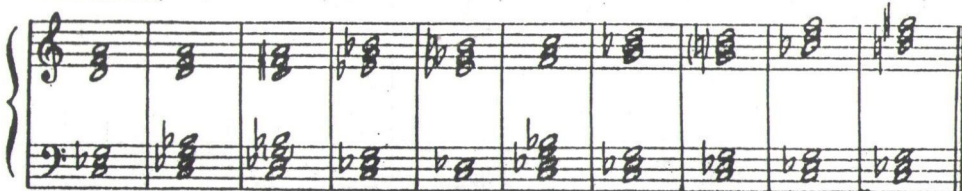


EXAMPLE 1 (Polychords-continued)

Dominant 7th Family



Minor 7th Family



It is important to observe the role of the 5th of the bottom chord of the polychord. The 5th is a chord member which is always dispensable unless altered. Therefore, when the upper triad includes a tone which could be analyzed as the 5th of the bottom chord in an altered form, a decision must be made whether or not to include the unaltered 5th of the bottom triad. Often either choice would be acceptable; if the unaltered 5th is included, the altered 5th of the upper chord would then seem to be either a raised 11th or flat 13th. If the unaltered 5th is omitted, then the alteration would probably be heard as a flat-5 or sharp-5.

As may be observed, some of the polychords shown here merely create a simple 7th or 9th chord rather than some complex sonority. However, this approach to the voicing of that harmony may be desirable in some instances. Also, only the conventional polychords are presented here. There are many others possible which might be considered too harsh a dissonance as an isolated harmonic block, but which might be used effectively for melodic-harmonic motion. This will generally be true if the dissonant polychord occurs in a position of weak rhythmic emphasis, if the dissonance resolves, or if it is used in the harmonization of a smooth, flowing melodic line. An example of polychord harmonization is shown here.

Polychords in melodic-harmonic motion:



In the examples given here, the two chords of each polychord are shown in root position. However, in application, it is often desirable to expand and/or invert either of the two chords to achieve a richer sound. In doing so, the chord tones of the two chords should not become intermingled if a true polychord quality is to be maintained. This is shown in the section of typical voicings.

EXAMPLE 3 Typical voicings:

Major Family (C Maj. 7, C Maj. 6/9, etc.)



Dominant Family (C7, C9, etc.)



Minor Family (Cmi.7, Cmi.6/9, etc.)



SUSPENDED FOURTH CHORD VOICINGS

A suspended 4th chord is simply a chord that has the tone a 4th above the root in place of the 3rd. A suspended triad, therefore, would have a root, 4th and 5th; a 7th chord would have the root, 4th, 5th and 7th, and so on.

In traditional harmony, these suspensions always resolved but, in contemporary usage, they may either resolve or progress to another chord without resolution. A suspended chord which resolves may be seen in example 1 while example 2 shows a series of unresolved suspended chords. An example of a song which consists exclusively of unresolved suspended 4th chords is Herbie Hancock's *Maiden Voyage*.

EXAMPLE 1.

EXAMPLE 1 shows a progression of chords: D m1 9, G13 sus4, G13, and C Maj. 7. The G13 sus4 and G13 chords are shown with a 4th and 3rd respectively, indicating resolution.

EXAMPLE 2.

EXAMPLE 2 shows a series of unresolved suspended chords: F 7sus, A 7sus, B 7sus, B 7sus, and F 7sus.

There are two main ways of conceiving and notating suspended harmonies. The first is to create a harmonic block and then to replace the 3rd of the chord with the tone a 4th above the root, indicating the resultant sound in the manner of example 3. The second way is to conceive of a sort of polychord; that is, a certain chord over a single bass note (pedal). The only considerations then are that the upper chord must have as a chord member, the tone a 4th above the single bass note and that the 3rd above that bass note should normally be absent. This method is shown in example 4. A third way to notate a suspended chord is to indicate it as an 11th chord (not a sharp-11th), which implies the omission of the third. This way, which is less common usage, is shown in example 5.

EXAMPLE 3

EXAMPLE 3 shows a progression of chords: G13, G13 sus.4, F M9, FM9/G pedal=G13sus.4, G11, and G11 (sus.4).

EXAMPLE 4

EXAMPLE 5

Some types of suspended chords seem to duplicate each other as can be seen in example 6. In these instances, the vertical sonority is the same but each chord has a different implication regarding the choice of scale form for improvisation.

EXAMPLE 6

EXAMPLE 6 shows four different chord symbols: C sus.4, C m1. sus.4, C7 sus.4, and C m1.7 sus.4, all of which result in the same vertical sonority.

Example 7 shows a number of common suspended 4th chord structures with both types of chord symbols used in some cases. Some typical voicings of those basic structures are shown in example 8.

EXAMPLE 7 Basic Structures

EXAMPLE 7 shows various suspended 4th chord structures: C9 sus., C13 sus., C9 sus., C13 sus., C13 sus., C sus. (add 9), C sus., and C7 sus. Below the notation are labels for the bass notes: G m1.7/C ped., G m1.9/C ped., B 7/C ped., B 9 M9/C ped., D m1.7/C ped., and D m1.9/C ped.

EXAMPLE 8 Typical voicings

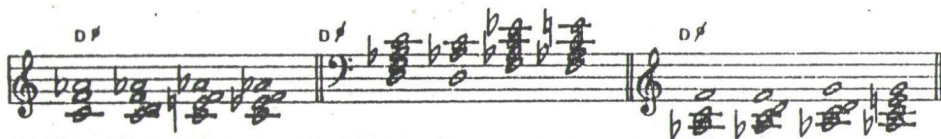
EXAMPLE 8 shows typical voicings for various suspended 4th chords.

APPLICATIONS TO MINOR KEYS

Most voicing principles apply to a minor key as well as major and several areas involving minor family chords have already been discussed. However, there are some general considerations that could be mentioned at this point. The II chord in a minor key is usually a half-diminished chord and the VII chord (replacing V) is a fully diminished 7th chord. Since the voicing of these chord types has not been covered yet, they will be discussed at this time.

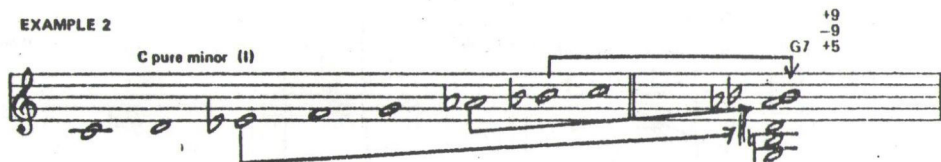
It will be found that most of the voicings shown in this book for minor 7th family chords may be converted to half-diminished voicings by simply lowering the 5th of the chord. However, it may or may not be desirable to lower the 9th if it is present in the voicing. The lowered 9th of a II chord is inherent to the minor tonality (I) but is also quite dissonant to the chord.

EXAMPLE 1



The half-diminished 7th built on II is generally followed by a V chord which is altered. This alteration is a good practice because the tonality of the minor I chord to follow implies a #5, b9 and #9 in the dominant 7th chord.

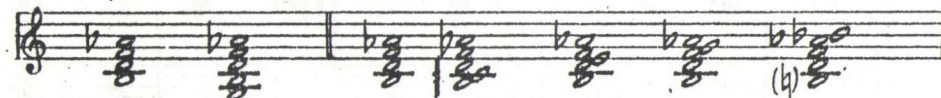
EXAMPLE 2



The diminished 7th chord occurs as a diatonic VII chord in the harmonic minor scale giving it a strong tendency toward a minor chord a half-step above. There are two general approaches to the voicing of this type of chord: 1 It is often considered an incomplete dominant 7th with a b9 and, accordingly, the root is added a major 3rd below the existing root; 2 To avoid a traditional sounding chord, one or more notes may be added a whole step above any chord member of a diminished 7th chord. Examples of these two methods are shown below.

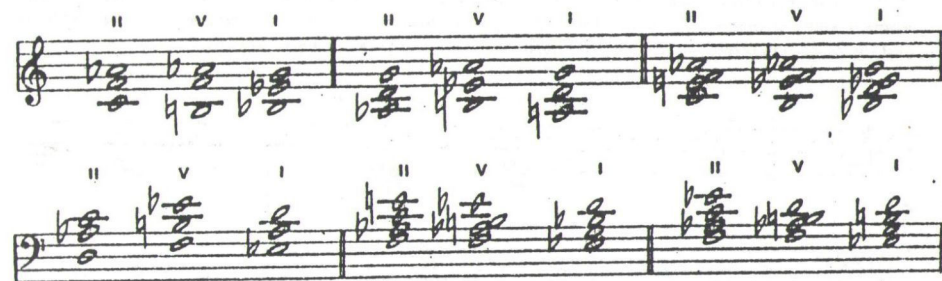
EXAMPLE 3a

EXAMPLE 3b



In a major key, a II to V to I progression usually involves a minor 7th, followed by a dominant 7th, followed by a major 7th. In a minor key, the II-V-I progression is usually a half-diminished 7th, followed by an altered dominant 7th, followed by a minor 7th or minor 6th chord. The last examples in this section show voicings for II-V-I progressions which have been adapted from a major key by lowering the 5th of the II chord, altering the V chord, and lowering the 3rd and/or 7th of the I chord.

EXAMPLE 4 Some possible chord connections:



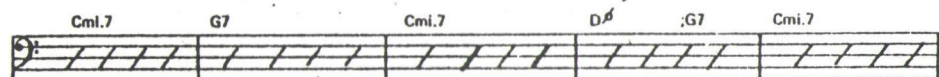
THE FUNCTION OF CHORDS

Each type of chord has one or more functions; that is, ways in which it normally progresses to other chords. This basic function is unaffected by the addition of higher extensions of the chord or by the alteration of certain chord members. Such extensions or alterations tend to only affect the relative dissonance or fullness of the chord.

Major 7th family chords tend to function as tonic chords, or ones which establish a key (ex., an E^bM7 in the key of E^b). They are relatively stable and do not need to progress to another chord. A series of major 7th chords creates a rather "soft" progression which lacks strong drive. In selecting chord qualities, it is important to remember that a major 7th chord could always suggest at least a temporary key center.

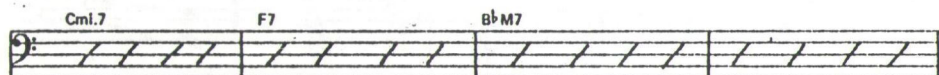
Minor 7th family chords are slightly less stable and have more than one primary function. They may serve either as a tonic chord in a minor key (Imi7) or as a supertonic chord in a major key (IImi7). If the minor 7th is long enough in duration and is preceded by a dominant 7th chord located a 5th above, it will probably assume a tonic function. In the following example, the Cmi7 assumes a tonic function in the key of C minor.

EXAMPLE 1



However, if the minor 7th is followed by a dominant 7th located a 5th below, it will probably function like a II chord. The Cmi7 in the next example functions as a II chord in a B^b major.

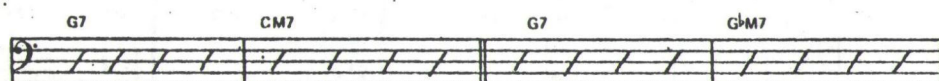
EXAMPLE 2



Any minor 7th chord could be assigned the function of a II chord and be followed by a dominant 7th a 5th below.

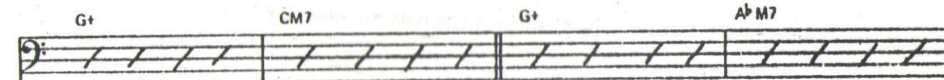
Dominant 7th family chords are still less stable and normally want to progress to the chord located either a half-step below or a perfect 5th below. A notable exception is in a blues progression where a dominant 7th commonly assumes the function of a tonic chord and may not progress normally. However, a dominant 7th is usually given the function of either a V chord or a II chord. Any dominant 7th chord could be assigned the function of a V chord and be preceded by the minor 7th a 5th above (its II chord). The following example shows the two most common resolutions of a dominant 7th.

EXAMPLE 3a



Augmented triads function similarly to a dominant 7th and may resolve to the chord a 5th below. However, as the next example shows, they may resolve upward a half-step.

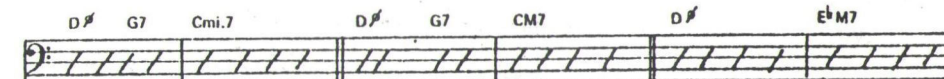
EXAMPLE 4a



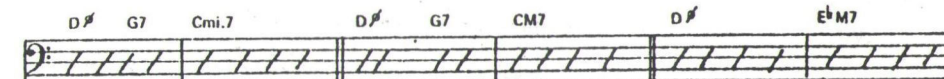
EXAMPLE 4b

Half-diminished 7th chords assume the function of a II chord in a minor key but may be used as a II chord in major as well. Occasionally, a half-diminished chord may function as a VII chord and resolve upward a half-step. In this function, it is actually a substitute for the V chord, a dominant 7th located a major 3rd below.

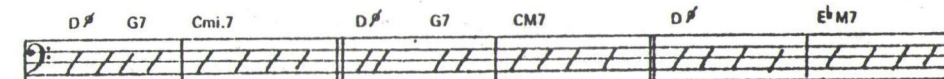
EXAMPLE 5a



EXAMPLE 5b



EXAMPLE 5c



Diminished 7th chords are very tense and normally progress step-wise up or down to either a major or minor chord. They are often considered incomplete dominant 9th chords and may have a new root added to them a major 3rd below the original root. There may be some confusion in the analysis of diminished 7ths since their spellings have several enharmonic equivalents. This can generally be resolved by observing the relationship of the chord to its resolution.

An extremely important consideration to keep in mind when analyzing chord progressions is that jazz harmony is constantly modulating or changing keys. A major or minor chord preceded by a dominant 7th located either a half-step above or a 5th above is usually evidence of the arrival of a new key center. However, the existence of some intermediate keys in a progression may be quite brief and in cycling progressions of 5ths may be debatable. It is very important to observe the relationships of the root progressions and the qualities of successive chords. A thorough understanding of these things then makes it possible to reproduce a given chord progression in any key desired. This skill is very important to any musician but especially to the player of a chord instrument.

The following is a brief summary of the appropriate chord types in some general harmonic situations:

Major key The tonic chord (I) may be a major triad, M69, M7, M7^b5, M7[#]5, etc. The V chord is usually a dominant 7th and the II chord could be either a minor 7th, half-diminished or dominant 7th.

Minor key The I chord could be a minor triad, mi69, mi7, or a mi[#]7. The V chord is usually a dominant 7th (with alterations) and the II chord is either a half-diminished or a dominant 7th (usually with alterations).

Major blues The I chord is generally a dominant 7th chord. All other functions are normal for a major key.

Because of extensive key changes in many jazz tunes, it is often possible to analyze entire pieces and be able to account for every chord in the progression as either a II, V or I chord in some key. However, modulations are often not completed as in the case of the many unresolved II to V progressions in tunes of the bebop era. All that is necessary for the establishment of a key feeling (no matter how brief) is two chords in a primary relationship to each other (such as II-V, V-I, I-IV, IV-I, etc.). A chart is included here to show the normal functions of the various chords within a single key.

THE FUNCTION OF CHORDS *

The Roman numerals in this chart indicate the degree of the scale of the key on which the chord is built. For example, a **II7** in the key of **E^b** is built on the second scale step which is **F**.

IM7	Establishes the key center, doesn't need to progress.
V7	Progresses to I (down a 5th)
II^{mi}7	Progresses to V (down a 5th) or to bII (down a ½ step)
VI^{mi}7	Substitute for I , progresses to II (down 5th) or to bVI (down ½ step)
VII7	Progresses to II (down 5th) or to bVI (down ½ step)
III^{mi}7	Substitute for I , often follows V7 , progresses to VI (down 5th) or to bIII (down ½ step)
II7	Progresses to VI (down 5th) or to bIII7 (down ½ step)
I7	Progresses to V (down 5th) or to bII (down ½ step)
IV7	Progresses to IV (down 5th) for temporary key change for relief
IVM7	Temporary key center for relief from original key.
V^{mi}7	II^{mi}7 of IV , progresses to I7 (down a 5th) and then to IV
VII⁷	Progresses to I , substitute for V
IV^{mi}7	Transitional chord between IVM7 and return to I , or between II^{mi}7 and I
bVII7	Transitional chord between IV^{mi}7 and I , may progress to bIII (down 5th)
bIII7	Substitute for VII7 , progresses to II (down ½ step) or to bVI (down 5th)
bVI7	Substitute for II7 , progresses to V (down ½ step) or to bII (down 5th)
bII7	Substitute for V7 , progresses to I (down ½ step)

*7-Dominant 7th, M7-Major 7th, mi7-minor 7th

TRI-TONE SUBSTITUTIONS*

*Tri-tone equals 3 whole steps

Any two dominant 7th-type chords whose roots are located a tri-tone apart will substitute for each other.

In C Major, in the progression **II^{mi}7-V7-IM7** (**D^{mi}7-G7-CM7**), a **D^b7** may replace the **G7** (**V7**) making the progression **II^{mi}7-bII7-IM7** (**D^{mi}7-D^b7-CM7**). The **D^b7** and **G7** are a tri-tone apart.

EXAMPLE 1

In C Major, in the progression **IM7-VII7-II^{mi}7** (**CM7-A7-D^{mi}7**), an **E^b7** may replace the **A7** making the progression **IM7-bIII7-II^{mi}7** (**CM7-E^b7-D^{mi}7**). The **E^b7** and **A7** are a Tri-tone apart.

EXAMPLE 2

This is in line with the two most common jazz progressions: down a perfect 5th or down a ½ step. In either case, the final chord of the progression is reached in one of two ways. In many cases, the substitute chord may be an exact duplication of the original chord with only the root changed. However, the analysis extensions and alterations in the chord would, of course, be different when the chord has a different

EXAMPLE 3 Substitutions with only the root changed.

USES OF TRI-TONE SUBSTITUTIONS:

1. To break a monotonous chain of progressions of 5ths or $\frac{1}{2}$ steps by converting one or more of them (the progressions) to the other type.
2. To add harmonic interest to a simple progression.
3. To provide an opportunity for a sudden *wild* departure from the key for temporary relief.
4. To lead an improvisation into different melodic territory.

EXAMPLE 4 Formulas for tri-tone substitutions.

(A) $7+5+9=13+11$

(B) $7-5-9 = \text{triad}$

(C) $7+5-9 = 9$

(D) $13-9 = 7+9$

(E) $7-9 = 7-9$

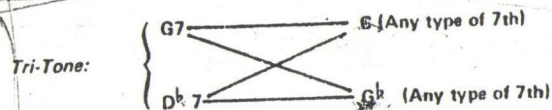
EXAMPLE 5

There are only SIX tri-tone root relationships with enharmonic variations.

C - $F^\sharp(G^\flat)$ $D^\sharp(C^\sharp) - G$ D - $A^\sharp(G^\flat)$ $E^\sharp(D^\sharp) - A$ $B^\sharp(A^\sharp) - E$ B - F

ALTERNATE RESOLUTIONS:

Both of the chords which serve as tri-tone substitutions for each other resolve commonly to either of two chords which are a tri-tone apart.



Therefore, for increased flexibility in using tri-tone substitutions, attention should be given to the resolution of melodic ideas based on dominant 7th's so that they may lead smoothly to the chord a $\frac{1}{2}$ step below or a perfect 5th below.

AN APPLICATION OF THE TRI-TONE PRINCIPLE

The following examples show the step-by-step evolution of a typical two-bar phrase ending. Through application of the tri-tone substitution principle, the space previously occupied by one or two simple chords may be filled by twice as many chromatically interesting chords. The examples here show a gradual elaboration on the original progression. However, once the principle is understood, the intermediate steps need not exist in one's thinking.

Example 1 shows a typical phrase which ends in the key of C and turns around to begin a new phrase in the same key.

EXAMPLE 1 FIRST MEASURE (New Phrase)

CM9 G13 CM9

In example 2, the III and VI chords are substituted for I in the first measure and the V chord is expanded to become a II to V progression.

EXAMPLE 2

Emi.7 Ami.7 Dmi.7 G13 CM9

III VI II V I

In example 3, the III, VI and II chords have undergone a quality change, becoming dominant chords. This, plus the fact that all four dominant 7th's have been altered, gives the progression a much stronger harmonic drive.

EXAMPLE 3

E7+9 A13-9 D7+9 G7+9 CM9

III VI II V I

Example 4 shows the actual application of the principle of tri-tone substitution; all four dominant 7th's have been replaced by their tri-tone alternates (B^b replaces E, E^b replaces A, A^b replaces D, and D^b replaces G). Notice that in making these substitutions the only thing that has been changed in each case is the root of the chord. By reinterpreting the analysis of the voicing which appears above the root, the $E7 \#5 \#9$ becomes a $B^b 13$, etc. Some enharmonic respelling has occurred as a result of the new root.

EXAMPLE 4

Example 5 illustrates a combination (there are many possible) of examples 3 and 4 with additional quality changes in the third and fourth chords. By changing the A^b and D^b chords to major qualities, the progression begins to sound like bVI to V to I to IV in the key of A^b until the abrupt return of the I chord in C . A quick examination of the functions of these chords should explain this curious phenomenon; a dominant 7th progressing down a 5th to a major 7th will always sound like V to I .

EXAMPLE 5

The possibilities available for substitution through the application of the tri-tone principle are so vast as to almost escape the imagination. But the important guideline in applying the principle may well be this: *If the origin of the substitution can be traced through a harmonic logic such as that presented in examples 1 through 4, then the substitution will probably be convincing and have harmonic integrity.*

MELODY HARMONIZATION

Anyone who has ever tried to harmonize melodies from rather sketchy lead sheets knows that it is often a challenge to supply interesting chords to a simple melody. This is especially true in the case of many old songs found in fake books where usually only the barest outline of the harmony is provided. However, applying the principles of chord functions and substitutions, it is relatively easy to produce harmony which satisfies the progression and/or an interesting variation.

The first example shows a four-bar melodic phrase with only one C chord indicated for the entire phrase. This is a fairly common harmonic situation.

EXAMPLE 1

EXAMPLE 1

In example 2, the phrase has been harmonized with diatonic chords which progress in 5th's, eventually returning to I (the C chord). In essence, all the harmony really does is turn around without actually going anywhere, while providing harmonic motion and quite a bit more interest. This is a very good device to use when additional tension is not desired in the harmony.

EXAMPLE 2

Example 3 is similar to number 2 except that the A minor, D minor and C major chords are all preceded by a dominant 7th chord whose root is located a half-step above. Since dominant 7th chords resolve strongly to either the chord a 5th below or a half-step below, this is a good way to add a strong harmonic drive to the progression. Practically any chord can be approached from the chord located either a 5th or a half-step above.

EXAMPLE 3

EXAMPLE 3

In example 4, the progression has departed slightly from the traditional functions and substitutions but the chromatic alterations are kept to a minimum. In this way, the harmonic texture is still relatively calm. Notice that the bass line which is created by the roots of the chords is smooth and flowing and that the final resolution has been changed to a substitute for I.

EXAMPLE 4

Chord progression: C Maj., G13, FMaj., Emi., Eb Maj., E7 +9, A mi.

Bass line roots: I, V, IV, III, bIII, VI

The final example offers the most harmonic tension for two main reasons. First, the harmony is more extensively altered. Secondly, the bass line created by the roots of the chords is considerably more angular, moving primarily in intervals of a 5th.

EXAMPLE 5

Chord progression: CMaj., FMaj., F#7, B7, Emi., Bb7, Ami., Ab Maj., Db Maj., C Maj.

Bass line roots: I, IV, II, V, I, bII, I, I, IV, I

KEY: C Maj. — Emi. — Ami. — Ab Maj. — C Maj.

An analysis of the chord functions reveals the following: I to IV in C Major, II-V-I in E minor, bII to I in A minor, I to IV in Ab Major, and a chromatic return to C Major. It is because of the logic of the modulating functions that this phrase is harmonically convincing, if somewhat removed from the original harmonic texture.

MELODY HARMONIZATION

SOME POSSIBILITIES FOR THE HARMONIZATION OF A GIVEN MELODY NOTE.

The given note (G) could be analyzed as any chord member unaltered or altered, of a chord of practically any quality (major, minor, dominant, etc.).

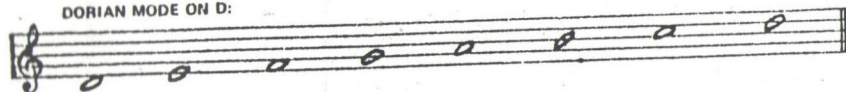
Chord possibilities for G:

- G13
- Gmi.7
- GM9
- Emi.11
- Eb M7
- CM8 9
- Cmi.11
- C# mi.7-9
- B7+9
- Ami.9
- Ab M9
- FM6
- F13
- Fmi.9
- F# 7-9
- Eb7+9
- Dmi.11
- Db M6
- Bb 13
- Bbm13

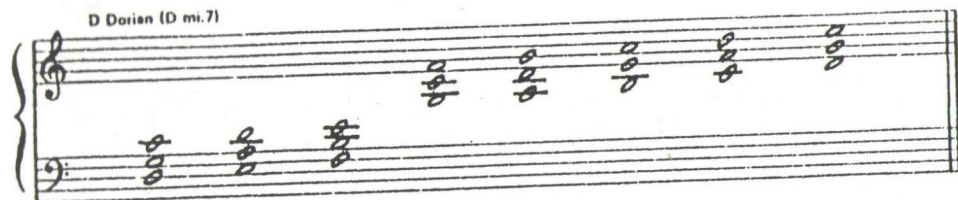
MODAL VOICINGS

Practically any voicing may be moved in similar motion, scale-wise through a given mode. This motion generates a variety of sonorities, some more or less dissonant than others. The harmonic motion should be conceived as having a horizontal, melodic nature relating to the entire scale, rather than a single vertical harmony.

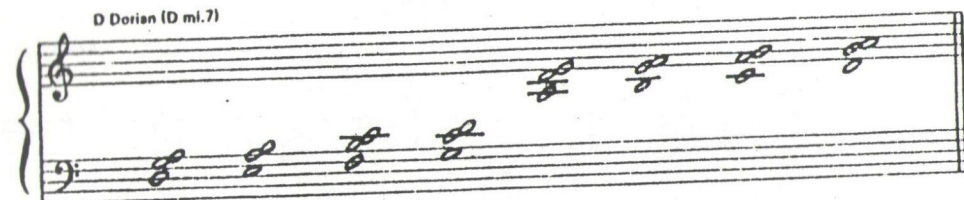
DORIAN MODE ON D:



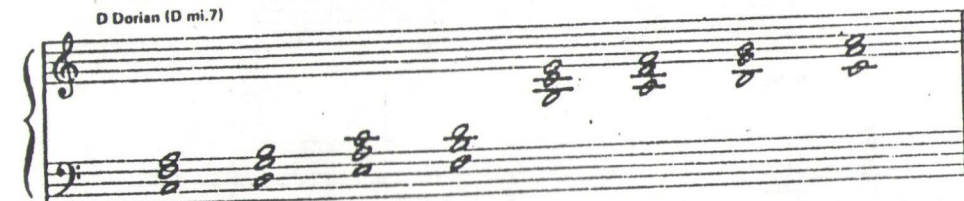
D Dorian (D mi.7)



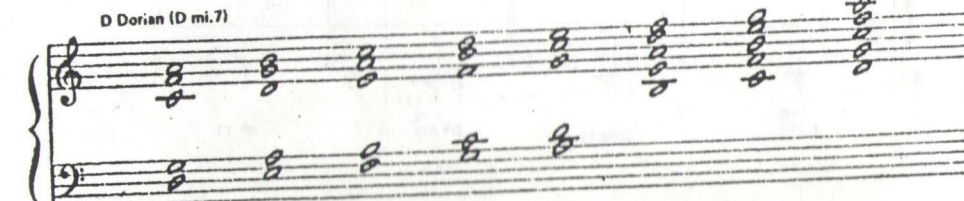
D Dorian (D mi.7)



D Dorian (D mi.7)

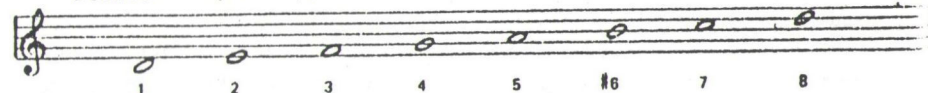


D Dorian (D mi.7)



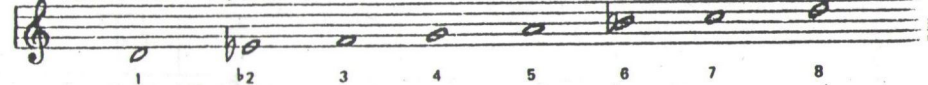
Usually, voicing patterns which involve the tone (s) unique to the particular mode are used. For example, in D dorian, the raised 6th scale step (B natural) is the tone that clearly identifies the mode as being dorian rather than pure minor. Therefore, patterns such as the following are common:

D DORIAN (pure minor, #6)



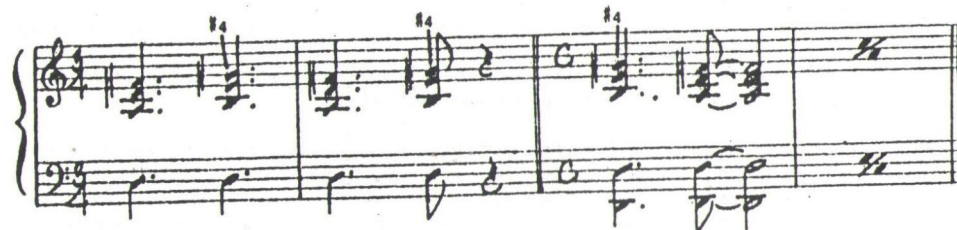
In the phrygian mode, the lowered 2nd scale step is the identifying tone of the mode:

D PHRYGIAN (pure minor, b2)



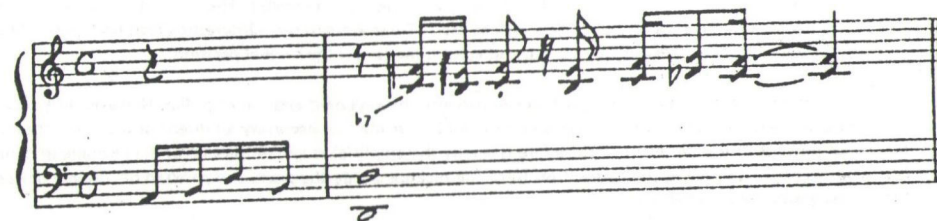
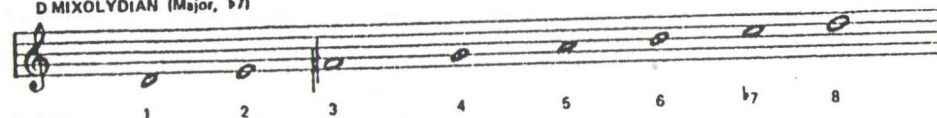
In the lydian mode, the raised 4th scale step is unique to the mode.

D LYDIAN (Major, #4)



In the mixolydian mode, it is the lowered 7th scale step which identifies the tonality.

D MIXOLYDIAN (Major, b7)



CHROMATIC PARALLEL MOTION

To add harmonic interest and/or tension to a given chord, chromatic parallel motion may be used in approaching, embellishing or leaving that particular sonority. In the following examples, a C minor voicing is used at the asterisk points to satisfy the basic harmonization of the phrase. Notice that the chord of longest duration in each example is always a voicing which reinforces a C minor tonality; that is, the chord which is called for in the progression.

Examples 1 and 2 show the approach to the C minor harmony from either a half-step below or above. The C tonality occurs in a strongly accented position which helps emphasize its arrival. The first of the two measures in these examples might be almost any chord. The voicing which occurs a half-step away from its eventual resolution is not objectionable since it is a chromatic anticipation of the tonality of the second measure. Also, the first chord in each case is of short rhythmic duration.

EXAMPLE 1



EXAMPLE 2

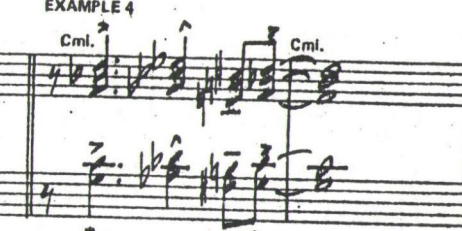


Embellishment of a harmony which lasts for two measures is shown in examples 3, 4 and 5. Here, the C minor chord is sounded and moved away from chromatically, only to return very soon. This type of motion creates tension since the chromatic harmonies foreign to the tonality are of sufficient duration and appear in an accented position in the measure. Example 6 moves a little farther away from the C tonality but still returns to a strong statement of that chord.

EXAMPLE 3



EXAMPLE 4



EXAMPLE 5

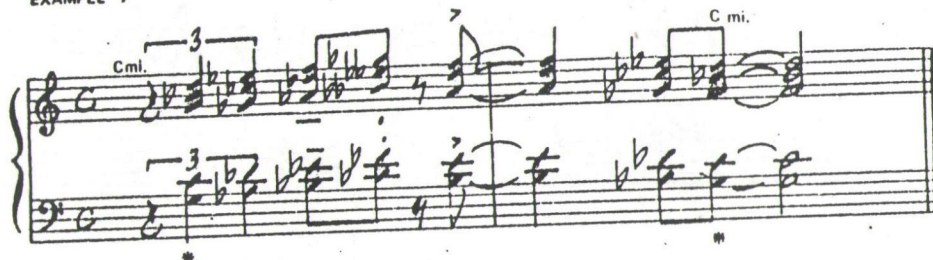


EXAMPLE 6



In example 7 we see melodic motion moving still farther away from the tonality and actually giving emphasis to a chord which is dissonant to it on the last half of the fourth beat in the first measure. Naturally, this creates even more tension until the resolution is heard at the end of the phrase.

EXAMPLE 7



The last example (8) shows a kind of free melodic motion which results in the voicing moving parallel in and out of the C minor tonality several times. This adds a great deal of interesting coloration to a harmony which has a long duration of 4 or 8 measures or longer. This is the case in many modal tunes. In this application, it is important that the melody created by the highest voice be *very smooth*. Stepwise movement or skips no larger than a third are most advisable.

EXAMPLE 8



ELECTRONIC KEYBOARD APPLICATIONS

Since there are a number of electric pianos and organs in wide use today, it seems pertinent to mention some considerations relative to those instruments as well as some of their possibilities.

In general, most voicing principles related to the acoustic piano will apply equally well to electronic keyboards. However, there are two general exceptions:

- 1 Thick, closely voiced chords, which sound full on acoustic piano may be too harsh or dissonant when played on electric piano or organ.
- 2 Two or Three-note voicings, which sound thin or weak on acoustic piano, may sound full and strong on an electric keyboard because of electronic amplification.

Unlike the acoustic piano, which has little sustaining power, an electronic keyboard may be used effectively to play melodic lines in combination with other instruments. Also, various amplifying sources for electric instruments make possible the use of such effects as vibrato, tremelo, reverberation and tone control. In addition, there are a number of modifying devices which, when used with an electric keyboard, can produce a rich variety of tone colors. Some of these devices are listed and described below:

- 1 **VOLUME PEDAL** — allows the foot to control volume so both hands are available to the keyboard.
- 2 **WAH-WAH PEDAL** — essentially a filter which either allows or greatly reduces the number of high frequencies present in the tone quality of the instrument. This is sometimes combined with either the volume or fuzz-tone pedals.
- 3 **FUZZ-TONE** — a distortion device which adds a tense quality to the tone. This is generally suited only for melodic use as it tends to distort chords too badly.
- 4 **REVERBERATION UNIT** — adds a *spacious* quality to the tone which simulates the illusion of playing in a large hall.
- 5 **RING MODULATOR** — a device which combines the sound of the instrument with that of a variable pitch oscillator to create both a difference tone and a combination tone. The oscillator has a range of about six octaves and the degree of modulation is controllable. At one end of the scale, only the keyboard tone is heard and at the other end, the original keyboard tone disappears completely.
- 6 **LESLIE SPEAKER** — this is a type of speaker-amplifier which has a speaker horn that is continuously turning in a 360 degree circle. The horn may turn at both slow and fast speeds creating a pleasing tremelo effect.
- 7 **PHASE SHIFTER** — a device which has a pulsating effect similar to a leslie speaker and creates the illusion of a continuous tone quality change.
- 8 **ECHO-PLEX** — essentially a tape recorder with an extra playback head so that whatever has just been played (recorded) can be played back immediately at any desired interval of delay and as many times as wanted. The volume of the echo in relation to the original is also adjustable. Since the device employs a tape loop of about two minutes duration, this entire loop may be played back while recording other material on top of that which was previously recorded. Therefore, it is possible for one to play duets, trios, even quartets with himself! There are also some interesting feed-back possibilities which involve increasing the sustain and volume levels past the normal position.

Most of these devices may be simply patched between the keyboard and the amplifier. However, in the case of at least one electric piano with its own built-in amplifier, it may be necessary to interrupt the connection of the actual pickups *inside the instrument* before it enters the amplifier stage. In the case of the example in mind, it is only necessary to unplug the connection from the pickups inside the piano and patch in the desired devices before going into the preamplifier.

Undoubtedly, much of the information in this section will either be obsolete or *old hat* by the time it appears in print. However, it is hoped that the ideas presented here will be of some use.

BLUES PROGRESSIONS (IN C) VOICED FOR THE LEFT HAND

1. POP-ROCK BLUES PROGRESSION

C9 (1 9 is optional) F 13

C9 G 13 F 13 C9 G 13

2. POP-ROCK PROGRESSION, (VARIATION OF No. 1)

C 13 F 9

C 13 G 9 F 9 C 13 G 9

3. SWING ERA, Typical Progression

C 13 F 13 C 13 F 13 Bb 13

C 13 A7 +9 D mi.9 G 13 -9 C 13 D mi.9 G7 +9

4. BEBOP ERA, Chromatic Blues Progression

C M9 B mi.9 E7 +5 A mi.9 A b mi.9 G mi.9 C7 +5 F M9 F mi.9 Bb 13

E mi.9 A 13 E b mi.9 A b 13 D mi.9 G7 +5 C M9 A7 +5 D mi.9 G7 +5

EXAMPLES OF BLUES PROGRESSIONS (In the Key of F)

Measure No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1.	F7	F7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	C7	F7	F7	F7
2.	F7	F7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	C7	Bb7	F7	C7
3.	F7	Bb7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	G7	C7	F7	C7
4.	F7	Bb7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	G7	C7	F7	C7
5.	F7	Bb7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	Gmi7	C7	F7	C7
6.	F7	Bb7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	D7	C7	F7	C7
7.	F7	Bb7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	D7	C7	F7	C7
8.	F7	Bb7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	D7	C7	F7	C7
9.	F7	Bb7	F7	F7	Bb7	Bb7	F7	F7	D7	C7	F7	C7
10.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7
11.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7
12.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7
13.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7
14.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7
15.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7
16.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7
17.	F M7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7	E mi7 A7 D mi7 G7 C mi7 F7 Bb7

NOTE: Portions of these progressions could be combined with each other to create hundreds of slight variations of the above. Notice that practically all blues progressions follow a similar basic form, which is as follows: First 4 measures - 1 chord; Second 4 measures - 13 chord (returning to a 1 chord or its substitute); Final 4 measures - V-chord (or ii-V substitute) returning to a 1 chord.

TURNAROUND PROGRESSIONS

A turnaround progression is usually a two-bar progression found at the end of an eight-bar phrase (Measures 7 and 8). The turnaround serves several purposes; 1 It relieves the monotony of hearing the tonic chord only for two measures, 2 It prepares the beginning of the next phrase, and 3 In many cases, it helps clarify the form by helping to emphasize the beginning of a new chorus. There are endless possibilities, of course, but some common turnarounds are shown here.

LEADING TO I				LEADING TO II			
III	VI	II	V	I	II	III	VI
I	bIII	II	bII	I	II	III	bIII
I	bIII	II	V	I	IV	III	VI
I	VI	bVI	V	I	VII	bVII	VI
I	bIII	bVI	V	I	IV	bVII	bIII
I	bIII	bVI	bII	I	bVII	VI	bIII
III	VI	bVI	bII	III	IV	III	bIII
I	VI	II	bII	I	VII	III	VI
bVII	VI	bVI	V	III	VI	bIII	bVI
I	bII°	II	V	I	V	I	#I°
I	bVII	I	bII	I	#I°	II	bIII
I	bVII	bIII	bII				
I	bVII	bVI	bII				

The II, V, and I chords will generally assume their normal qualities, that is, minor, dominant and major. However, experimentation with different families of chords will produce interesting variations. For example, a bIII chord might be effective as either a major, minor or dominant family chord. Also, qualities will be affected by whether the turnaround is used in a major or minor key.

II-V-I PROGRESSIONS

1. ALL MAJOR KEYS

B^b: II V I A^b II V I A^b II V I

G II V I G^b II V I F: II V I

E: II V I E^b: II V I D: II V I

D^b: II V I C: II V I B: II V I

II-V-I PROGRESSIONS

2. ALL MAJOR KEYS

Handwritten musical notation for the F major II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: F4, E4, D4, C4, B3, A3, G3, F3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: F3, E2, D2, C2, B1, A1, G1, F1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

F: II V I E: II V I Eb: II V I

Handwritten musical notation for the D major II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: D4, C4, B3, A3, G3, F3, E3, D3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: D3, C2, B1, A1, G1, F1, E1, D1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

D: II V I Db: II V I C: II V I

Handwritten musical notation for the B major II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: B4, A4, G4, F4, E4, D4, C4, B3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: B3, A2, G2, F2, E2, D2, C2, B1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

B: II V I Bb: II V I A: II V I

Handwritten musical notation for the Ab major II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: Ab4, Gb4, F4, Eb4, Db4, C4, Bb3, Ab3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: Ab3, Gb2, F2, Eb2, Db2, C2, Bb1, Ab1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

Ab: II V I G: II V I Gb: II V I

II-V-I PROGRESSIONS

3. ALL MINOR KEYS

Handwritten musical notation for the G minor II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: Gb4, F4, Eb4, Db4, C4, Bb3, Ab3, Gb3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: Gb3, F2, Eb2, Db2, C2, Bb1, Ab1, Gb1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

g: II V I f#: II V I f: II V I

Handwritten musical notation for the e minor II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: e4, d4, c4, b3, a3, g3, f3, e3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: e3, d2, c2, b1, a1, g1, f1, e1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

e: II V I eb: II V I d: II V I

Handwritten musical notation for the c# minor II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: c#4, b4, a4, g4, f4, e4, d4, c#3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: c#3, b2, a2, g2, f2, e2, d2, c#1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

c#: II V I c: II V I b: II V I

Handwritten musical notation for the bb minor II-V-I progression. The treble clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: bb4, ab4, gb4, fb4, eb4, db4, cb4, bb3. The bass clef contains a descending eighth-note scale: bb3, ab2, gb2, fb2, eb2, db2, cb2, bb1. The notes are grouped into three measures, each containing a dyad (II-V).

bb: II V I a: II V I ab: II V I

II-V-I PROGRESSIONS

4. ALL MINOR KEYS

c: II V I c#: II V I f: II V I

d: II V I a: II V I e: II V I

e: II V I b: II V I f#: II V I

f: II V I c: II V I g: II V I

CHORD SYMBOL APPENDIX

Major family - C, C6, C69, CM7, Cmaj.7, C-7 C Δ

Minor family - Cm, Cmi6, Cmin7, C-7, Cm $\sharp$ 7

Dominant family - C7, C9, C9+11, C13

Half-diminished - Cmi7-5, C $\flat$

Diminished - Cdim7, C $\flat$ 7

Augmented - C+, C+7

Suspended - C sus., C sus.4, Chord/C pedal or Chord/C bass

Added notes - Cadd 9, Cadd 4

Omitted notes - C omit 3